



Soft Tissue Grafting (Connective Tissue Graft, Free Gingival Graft)

Purpose: Surgical procedure to replace or augment gum tissue, often to cover exposed roots or increase tissue thickness.

First 24 Hours:

- Mild bleeding and swelling are normal.
- Apply ice packs externally in 15-minute intervals to control swelling.
- Avoid spitting, rinsing, or using straws for the first 24 hours.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Use prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Expect some tenderness at both the graft site and donor site.

Oral Hygiene:

- Brush and floss other areas normally, but avoid the graft and donor sites until advised.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinses as directed.
- Do not disturb the sutures or graft material.

Diet:

- Eat soft, cool foods for the first week.
- Avoid hot, spicy, acidic, or crunchy foods.

Special Precautions:

- Do not pull on lips or cheeks to look at the graft.
- Avoid smoking and alcohol, as they slow healing.
- Protect the graft area from trauma during chewing.

Follow-Up:

- Stitches may dissolve or require removal depending on type.
- Contact the office if graft tissue becomes loose, excessive bleeding occurs, or there are signs of infection.